COMPETITION REGULATIONS

Zalo AI Challenge 2026

1. General information and effectiveness of the regulations

1.1. Competition Information

Competition Name: The official name of the Competition is "Zalo AI Challenge 2026" (hereinafter referred to as the "Competition" or "Zalo AI Challenge").

Zalo AI Challenge 2026 is a skills competition organized by Zalo AI to promote the fields of data science and artificial intelligence in Vietnam.

1.2. Definitions

In these Regulations, the following terms shall have the meanings set out below:

"Organizer" / "Zalo" / "We": Zalo AI (VNG), the organizing entity responsible for implementing, administering, reviewing, and awarding prizes for the Competition.

"Contestant" / "Participant" / "You": An individual who meets the eligibility requirements under these Regulations and registers to participate in the Competition either individually or as a member of a Team.

"Team": A group of Contestants formed and participating in the Competition in accordance with these Regulations.

"Competition Website": The official Zalo AI Challenge online portal at https://challenge.zalo.ai, used for registration, submission, announcement of results, and updates relating to the Competition.

"Zalo Account": An individual account on the Zalo platform, used to register and verify the identity of a Contestant/Team.

"Competition Data": All training datasets, public test data, and private test data provided by the Organizer for research, development, and evaluation purposes within the Competition.

"Submission" / "Competition Entry": All source code, models, documentation, ideas, or products developed and submitted by a Contestant/Team during the Competition.

"Competition Code": Code developed by a Contestant during the Competition, including training code, testing code, or any code used to generate submission results.

"External Data": Lawful datasets declared by the Contestant and additionally used during training in accordance with these Regulations.

"Prize": A cash or in-kind reward awarded by the Organizer to Teams/individuals achieving high rankings based on duly verified results.

"Competition Period": The entire period from the start date through the announcement of the final results, including submission and prize evaluation milestones as announced on the Competition Website.

"Personal Data": Digital data or information in another form that identifies or helps identify a specific individual, including basic personal data and sensitive personal data.

"Data Subject": The individual to whom the Personal Data relates.

"Personal Data Protection Laws": All Vietnamese laws and regulations relating to the processing and protection of Personal Data, as amended from time to time, including but not limited to the 2025 Personal Data Protection Law and Decree No. 356/2025/ND-CP.

1.3. Effectiveness and Acceptance of the Regulations

These Regulations of the Zalo AI Challenge 2026 (hereinafter referred to as the "Regulations") shall take effect from the date on which they are officially published by the Organizer through the Competition's information channels and shall apply throughout the participation, judging, and prize-awarding process of the "Zalo AI Challenge 2026".

By registering for the Competition, the Contestant confirms that they have read, understood, and agreed to comply with all provisions of these Regulations, including the specific rules of each challenge published on the Competition Website and any amendments or supplements (if any). These Regulations constitute a legally binding agreement between the Organizer and the Contestant/Team governing the entire participation, judging, and prize-awarding process of the Competition.

You must agree to and comply with these Regulations in order to submit a Submission and be eligible to receive a Prize.

By participating in the Competition and downloading Competition Data, you agree to comply with Zalo's Terms of Use at https://zalo.vn/dieukhoan/.

2. Eligibility for registration, accounts, and teams

2.1. Eligibility

To be eligible to participate, you must meet all of the following criteria:

(i) Hold Vietnamese nationality;

(ii) Be the holder of a valid Zalo Account; and

(iii) Be at least 18 years old or have reached the age of majority under the laws applicable at your place of residence (unless otherwise agreed by the Organizer and you have obtained lawful consent from a parent/legal guardian).

If participating as a Team, the Team Leader must ensure that all Team members have been fully informed of and agreed to participate in the Competition under the terms and conditions of these Regulations.

If you participate on behalf of a company, educational institution, or other legal entity as an employee, collaborator, or representative, these Regulations shall bind both you and that organization. You represent that the organization is aware of and has authorized your participation and receipt of any Prize, and that your participation does not violate the organization's internal regulations.

Ineligible persons: Employees, collaborators, or any individuals who have entered into an employment contract, service contract, or are working for VNG and companies within the group are not permitted to register for the Competition in any form.

The Organizer reserves the right to verify eligibility and resolve disputes regarding eligibility in cases of suspected violations or at the Organizer's discretion.

2.2. Registration and Accounts

You are not required to purchase anything or make any payment to participate in the Competition or receive a Prize. To register, you must create an account on the Competition Website before the registration deadline and submit your Submission according to the instructions.

You may participate in the Competition individually or as part of a Team. Each individual may register for and participate in the Competition through only one (01) Zalo Account. Each member must register individually before joining a Team.

Each Contestant may participate in only one (01) Team or participate individually; a Contestant may not simultaneously participate in multiple Teams or participate both individually and as a Team member.

Contestants or Teams may not use multiple accounts, fake accounts, or create multiple Teams to submit Submissions and compete for Prizes contrary to these principles. Each Team member having a separate account for registration and participation in the same Team in accordance with these Regulations shall not be considered a violation.

2.3. Formation and Management of Teams

Each Team may have a maximum of five (05) members, including the Team Leader.

The Team Leader may remove or add members to the Team while continuing to comply fully with these Regulations.

Submissions made by members who have subsequently been removed from the Team shall remain counted toward the Team based on the time at which such individual made the Submission.

The Team Leader may request deletion of the Team provided that (1) no members remain in the Team and (2) the request is sent to the Organizer at aichallenge@zalo.me.

2.4. Team Merging

Team merging is permitted and shall be carried out by the Team Leader. After merging, the resulting Team must comply with the member limit and Team-related provisions of these Regulations.

Condition for merging Teams: The total number of Submissions made by the merged Team must not exceed the maximum number of Submissions permitted as of the time of merging. The maximum number of Submissions shall be calculated as: (Number of Submissions permitted per day) × (Number of Competition days elapsed as of the time of merging).

3. Competition categories and schedule

The challenge content, datasets, pre-trained models, and specific requirements for each challenge shall be published on the portal for each challenge on the Competition Website.

The Competition consists of two (02) rounds: the public test and the private test, taking place from October to December 2026, in the GMT+7 time zone, as follows:

October 26, 2026: Start the challenge. The development kit, data (training & public test), and evaluation software are made available.

November 16, 2026: Submit solutions. All teams submit solutions, including training code, testing code, and models. Deadline: 23:59 (GMT+7).

November 20, 2026: Release private test. The leaderboard is provisional, based on results submitted by participating teams and subject to verification. Release time: 9:00 (GMT+7).

November 23, 2026: Submit the final result. All teams submit their final results for the private test set. Deadline: 23:59 (GMT+7).

December 2, 2026: The top 2 teams per track will be announced.

December 12, 2026: Final results are announced.

The Organizer may change the schedule or add interim deadlines throughout the process. All updates will be announced on the Competition Website, and Participants are responsible for monitoring such updates.

You must convert the time zone to the applicable time zone at your place of residence to ensure timely submission.

4. Permitted data and resources

4.1. Competition Data

The Competition Data is divided into three (03) parts: training data, public test data, and private test data.

As a general principle, Contestants should use the Competition Data for training and validation. The Organizer does not encourage independently collecting data from other sources.

You may use Competition Data, including Personal Data contained in the datasets, solely for non-commercial and academic purposes, including: participating in the Competition; discussions on the challenge.zalo.ai forum; and academic or educational research. When using the datasets, you must cite “challenge.zalo.ai”. At the end of the Competition Period, you must delete or destroy Personal Data in accordance with personal data protection laws, data laws, and other applicable laws.

The Organizer makes no representation or warranty regarding the accuracy, ownership, or suitability of the data for any purpose other than those stated above.

4.2. Labeling and Additional Annotation

Contestants may add sub-labels or additional annotations to the provided training dataset. Manually labeled information or human predictions may not be used on validation or test datasets to create a Submission.

4.3. Data Security and Distribution Restrictions

You agree to apply reasonable and appropriate measures to prevent persons who are not participating in the Competition and/or persons who have not formally agreed to these Regulations from accessing or processing Competition Data.

Throughout the Competition Period, you may not privately share data outside your Team. You may not transmit, copy for provision, publish, redistribute, or provide the Competition Data, including Personal Data arising from or relating to the Competition, to any third party.

If you discover and/or suspect unauthorized access to or transmission of Competition Data, you must immediately notify the Organizer and cooperate in remediation.

4.4. External Data

If you participate in a category that permits the use of external datasets during training ("External Data"), you must comply with the following requirements:

External datasets must comply with applicable laws on artificial intelligence and Personal Data Protection Laws and must not violate Vietnamese customs and traditions.

If you upload External Data during training, you understand and agree that such External Data may contain Personal Data, and you confirm that you collected such data in compliance with Personal Data Protection Laws and obtained appropriate consent as required by law to use such External Data. You are responsible for the provision, processing, and use of External Data (if it contains Personal Data) and for obtaining consent from relevant Data Subjects for the purposes of the Competition in accordance with Personal Data Protection Laws.

If requested by the Organizer and/or a competent state authority to demonstrate compliance with Personal Data Protection Laws, the Team/Contestant shall cooperate by providing documents and evidence demonstrating compliance in using External Data.

If the Team cannot provide documents or evidence demonstrating legal compliance as requested by the Organizer, the Team must cease using and delete/destroy the External Data; otherwise, the Team's Submission shall be deemed invalid.

Data uploaded by Participants will be stored and processed in accordance with personal data protection laws, data laws, and other applicable laws.

You are solely responsible for uploading, processing, and using data, External Data, and Personal Data.

4.5. Use of Open Source

If your model uses open-source software, you may only use libraries or source code with a valid OSI-approved license (see opensource.org), without restrictions on commercial use, unless the copyright owner or an authorized author has provided written permission for use under other conditions compatible with participation in the Competition. The use of open source must ensure that it does not result in unauthorized access to, collection, storage, disclosure, provision, transfer, or processing of Personal Data in violation of applicable laws, the purposes of the Competition, or data protection requirements prescribed by the Organizer.

5. Submissions and submission process

5.1. Submission Limits and Requirements

Each Team or individual Contestant may submit a maximum of five (05) Submissions per day and may select only one (01) final Submission for official scoring.

Submissions must comply with the format, technical requirements, and deadlines specified on the Competition Website.

Late Submissions will not be counted.

A Submission is invalid if it is unclear, incomplete, improperly modified, falsified, or fraudulently submitted.

Contestants/Teams must submit valid Submissions at each stage as required to be considered for Prizes.

5.2. Model Freeze and Final Solution Submission

Before the private test data is released, the Organizer will require Teams/Contestants to freeze their models and submit the final solution, including training code, testing code, model, method description, and instructions for running the code.

All final Submissions will be uploaded to servers designated by the Organizer; technical details will be announced before the Competition begins. A model execution time limit will apply to the private test data, as specified in the description of each category.

6. Scoring, ranking, and result verification

6.1. Scoring and Ranking

Each Submission will be scored and ranked according to the evaluation metric published on the Competition Website. During the Competition, the public leaderboard will be updated in real time based on results from the public test set (where two Submissions receive the same score, the earlier Submission shall rank higher).

Winners are determined based on the results of the private test round, provided that they fully comply with these Regulations. If a winner is disqualified or declines a Prize, the next eligible Contestant with the next-highest score will be selected as a replacement.

6.2. Result Verification

When results are submitted on the private test data, the Organizer will check and compare them with the results generated by the frozen model.

The Organizer may require potential winners to provide source code and documentation demonstrating compliance before confirming the results.

The official leaderboard will be published on the Competition Website.

7. Prizes and prize claim procedures

7.1. Prize Structure

Each challenge has the following prize structure:

First Prize for each challenge: VND 90,412,000 in cash (equivalent to USD 3,500*).

Second Prize for each challenge: VND 64,580,000 in cash (equivalent to USD 2,500*).

*Converted based on the average buying/selling exchange rate of Vietnam Maritime Commercial Joint Stock Bank on October 23, 2026.

The Organizer will withhold applicable taxes in accordance with Vietnamese law before awarding Prizes to winning Contestants.

Prizes are announced on the Competition Website and are valid only during the specified period. The chance of winning depends on the number of valid Submissions and the skill level of the Contestants.

7.2. Prize Notification and Acceptance

Potential winners will be notified by email, telephone, and the Zalo application.

A potential winner will forfeit the right to receive the Prize if: (i) they do not respond within one (01) week from the first contact attempt; or (ii) they notify the Organizer that they do not wish to receive the Prize within one (01) week after the Competition ends.

To receive a Prize, the winner must fully perform the following obligations:

(a) Submit to the Organizer the final software source code used to create the winning Submission, together with documentation, running instructions, and necessary resources;

(b) Grant the Organizer a license to use the winning Submission in accordance with Section 8 of these Regulations;

(c) Sign and return all documents confirming receipt of the Prize, including (i) valid certification; and (ii) licenses, minutes, or other undertakings, if any.

The winner must submit the complete prize claim documents within two (02) weeks from the date of notification; otherwise, the Prize will be canceled. The Prize will be awarded within thirty (30) days after the Organizer receives all required documents. Prizes are non-transferable and may not be assigned.

7.3. Taxes

All taxes relating to the Prize are the responsibility of the winner, unless otherwise provided by law.

8. Intellectual property and code sharing

8.1. Ownership and Right to Use Submissions

The Competition Entry remains the property of its author; however, the Contestant/Team grants the Organizer a non-exclusive, perpetual, royalty-free right to use, quote, present, publish, or distribute the Competition Entry for research, promotional, educational, and communications purposes related to the Competition without further consent or additional payment.

8.2. Source Code Sharing

Unless expressly permitted on the Competition Website or in the specific rules of a challenge, throughout the Competition Period, you may not privately share Competition Code or

executable code developed based on Competition Data outside your Team. This includes sharing between different Teams, unless the Teams have been validly merged.

Except for the private sharing expressly permitted above, throughout the Competition Period, sharing Competition Code is permitted only if it is made publicly available to all Contestants on the official Competition forum. Public disclosure of code must not infringe third-party intellectual property rights or restrictions on sharing Competition Data. By publicly sharing code, you are deemed to have agreed to license such code under an Open Source Initiative (OSI)-recognized open-source license without restrictions on commercial use.

Contestants, particularly winning Teams/Contestants, are encouraged to publicly release their solutions (source code) after the Competition ends to contribute to the development of artificial intelligence (AI) in Vietnam.

9. Prohibited conduct and violation handling

9.1. Prohibited Conduct

Contestants must comply with the spirit and provisions of these Competition Regulations. Fraud, falsification, threats, scams, harassment, use of unauthorized tools, intentional disruption of the Competition Website, or conduct that negatively affects other Contestants, the fairness, or the reputation of the Competition is strictly prohibited.

Contestants may not provide false information regarding identity, place of residence, address, telephone number, email, ownership, or any other information relating to the Competition; use data for improper purposes or beyond the permitted scope; or otherwise violate these Regulations.

9.2. Violation Handling and Remediation

Any fraudulent conduct or violation of these Regulations may result in immediate disqualification at the Organizer's discretion. The Organizer has the right to reject non-compliant Submissions, suspend or terminate participation, cancel results, and/or remove violating Contestants/Teams from the leaderboard.

For remediable violations, the Organizer may permit or require the Contestant/Team to remedy the violation in accordance with these Regulations or the Organizer's decision. All Prizes are subject to the Organizer's verification of validity and compliance. If a winning Submission violates these Regulations and the violation is remediable, the Organizer may require

remediation within one (01) week, including resolving license conflicts, removing violating software, or fulfilling outstanding obligations.

Intentional disruption of the Competition Website or fraud may be subject to criminal and civil liability under Vietnamese law.

10. Collection, use, and protection of personal information and personal data

10.1. Scope and Purposes of Collection

By registering for the Competition, the Participant understands and agrees that the Organizer may collect, store, use, and process personal information and Personal Data relating to registration, participation, and prize awarding for the following purposes:

- **Verifying registered Participants and participation in the Competition**: We use information provided by Contestants to verify Contestants/Teams for registration and participation, including but not limited to verifying eligibility, validity of Submissions, and detecting and preventing impersonation, violations of the Regulations, and/or impacts on the judging system;
- **Notifying Contestants/Teams of Competition information:** We use Contestant/Team information to contact and notify them about Competition information and progress;
- **Evaluation and prize consideration:** We use Contestant/Team information to score, announce results, award Prizes, and perform related legal procedures;
- **Communication and promotion of the Competition:** We use the names, information, and images of Contestants/Teams, including Contestants/Teams that do not win, for publication, introduction, communications, and posting in the press, television, and partner channels in connection with the Competition and related programs, events, and activities. Participants agree that the Organizer and its affiliates may use their names and images within the scope stated above without additional compensation, unless otherwise required by law;
- **Development and improvement of the Competition:** We use information provided by Contestants/Teams to improve quality, optimize and technically process the Competition, enhance operational quality, ensure platform system security, and improve the Competition organization process; and
- **Compliance with laws:** including requests from competent state authorities or for audit and reporting purposes.

10.2. Types of Information Collected

a. Basic Personal Data provided by Participants, including: information provided by Contestants to identify themselves when creating an Account and throughout the Competition, including telephone number, full name, date of birth, gender, ID card/Citizen ID/Passport information, tax identification number, personal image, email address; city of residence; information about current or previous educational institutions; and

Team information provided includes the Team name, member list, roles, and contact information. The person providing Team members' Personal Data shall ensure that all members have provided appropriate consent in accordance with Personal Data Protection Laws before such data is provided.

b. Sensitive Personal Data provided by Participants, including:

Payment-related information: payment information voluntarily provided by Participants for prize payment purposes if they win, including bank account information for receiving Prizes.

c. Other data automatically collected by Us, including information relating to the operating system and device, such as version, default language, device signal quality, cookie information, battery status, application interaction data, connection status, incident data, performance, operating system, browser, network information, and similar types of data, as well as Account activity when using the Competition Website, including the time and frequency of Account activity on the Competition Website, activities performed by Participants through their Accounts, and incident reports.

10.3. Sharing, Storage, and Processing of Personal Data

Participants understand and consent that the Organizer will not share, disclose, or transfer Contestant information to any third party, except in the following cases:

- With the consent of the Contestant/Team for purposes under these Regulations;
- Upon a lawful request from a competent authority;
- When sharing is necessary for organizing, judging, or communicating the Competition and the recipient is subject to corresponding confidentiality obligations;
- Publication of the name, image, and Personal Data (to the extent necessary) of Contestants/Teams on official communication channels relating to the Competition and related programs, events, and activities for the purposes stated in these Regulations; and

- Other cases as provided by law.

In cases where Participants' personal information or Personal Data must be shared with a third party, the Organizer will ensure that such data is stored only for the period necessary to serve the purposes of the Competition Regulations and is protected in accordance with these Regulations, the Participant's consent, and/or applicable law.

The Organizer shall store and process Personal Data in accordance with personal data protection laws, data laws, and other applicable laws.

10.4. Exercise of Data Subject Rights

Contestants have the right to exercise Data Subject rights, including:

- Request access to, correction of, or updates to the personal information they have provided;
- Request the Organizer to delete, destroy, or cease processing data when they are no longer participating in the Competition; and
- Other rights provided by applicable law.

Contestants may contact the Organizer at aichallenge@zalo.me to exercise their rights relating to their personal information and shall follow the Organizer's response.

10.5. Security Measures

The Organizer undertakes to apply necessary technical and organizational measures to protect Contestants' Personal Data from loss, unauthorized access, alteration, disclosure, or destruction. All Personal Data processing activities shall comply with Personal Data Protection Law No. 91/2025/QH15, Decree No. 356/2025/ND-CP, and relevant Vietnamese laws.

10.6. Promotion and Communications

Participants understand and consent that the Organizer may send notices, invitations, or promotional information about the Competition and related artificial intelligence (AI) programs, events, and activities by email, the Zalo application, and the Organizer's communication channels. The frequency and content of communications will be controlled in compliance with applicable advertising laws.

11. Indemnification and limitation of liability

11.1. Representations and Indemnification

You represent that your Submission is your original work and does not infringe any third party's copyright or intellectual property rights.

You agree to indemnify and hold the Organizer harmless from any claims, damages, or costs arising from:

(a) The Submission's infringement of another person's copyright, trademark, patent, and/or confidentiality obligations;

(b) Provision of false information; use of Competition Data, External Data, or Personal Data in violation of these Regulations or applicable laws;

(c) Failure to comply with these Regulations or the law;

(d) Third-party claims relating to you; and

(e) Your receipt, use, or misuse of the Prize.

In the event of any dispute, complaint, lawsuit, and/or claim for compensation relating to or arising from data uploaded, processed, or used by you, you shall defend and hold the Organizer (including its employees, officers, and agents) harmless from all claims arising from or relating to the use of data and Personal Data, including but not limited to unauthorized copying or use of copyrighted materials.

11.2. Disclaimer of Liability

You release the Organizer from all liability relating to:

(a) Technical errors, errors in the Competition Website or systems, including network errors, connection interruptions, transmission errors, software/hardware damage, or Internet system errors affecting submission;

(b) Errors in data collection or processing; and

(c) Errors in printing, displaying, or announcing Prizes.

11.3. Relationship Between the Parties

Participation in the Competition or receipt of a Prize does not constitute an employment contract or an offer of employment with the Organizer.

You acknowledge that your participation is entirely voluntary and does not create an employment or agency relationship with the Organizer.

12. General provisions

12.1. Changes, Suspension, or Cancellation of the Competition

The Organizer has full discretion to consider, adjust, supplement, or amend these Competition Regulations, challenge content, competition format, schedule, and prize structure where necessary to ensure alignment with actual conditions.

Any changes (if any) will be publicly announced by the Organizer through the Competition's official channels and shall take effect from the time the notice is published.

If the Competition is affected by viruses, fraud, unauthorized interference, or other technical incidents that prevent normal operation, the Organizer has the right to cancel, stop, modify, or suspend the Competition.

12.2. Complaints and Decisions of the Organizer

All complaints relating to results or the organization of the Competition will only be accepted within 07 (seven) working days from the date the official results are announced.

The Organizer has the right to refuse to process complaints submitted after the above deadline or without valid supporting evidence.

In all cases, the Organizer's decision is final in matters relating to the organization, scoring, prize consideration, prize awarding, violation handling, and complaint resolution of the Competition; Contestants/Teams agree to accept such decision as a mandatory condition of participation.

12.3. Governing Law and Dispute Resolution

Unless otherwise provided in the specific rules of a challenge, all disputes arising from these Regulations shall be governed by the laws of Vietnam. The parties agree to submit to the jurisdiction of the courts of Vietnam. If any provision of these Regulations is invalid, the remaining provisions shall remain in effect.

12.4. Contact

All requests, notices, and complaints relating to the Competition shall be sent to the Organizer at aichallenge@zalo.me.